EquWord Quick Start for Mac

Gyeongcheol Cho

Software version 1.0.1

November 3, 2026

Document information

- Microsoft Word 16.114.3 (26102720)
- macOS 26.7.2 (build 25G332) on Apple silicon (arm64)
- Repository github.com/PsycheMatrica/EquWord
- License CC BY-NC-SA 4.0
- Use this guide with desktop Word for Mac to load EquWord, configure a manuscript, and practice conversion and equation layout. The Windows guide uses different installation menus.
- Screenshots show EquWord 1.0.0 in the Word environment above. The same steps apply to 1.0.1; menu labels may vary by Word build.

Find Word's Startup Folder

1. Extract the EquWord ZIP in Finder. Keep its contents in a stable folder, and locate EquWord.dotm. Use desktop Microsoft Word for Mac; Word for the web cannot run this template.

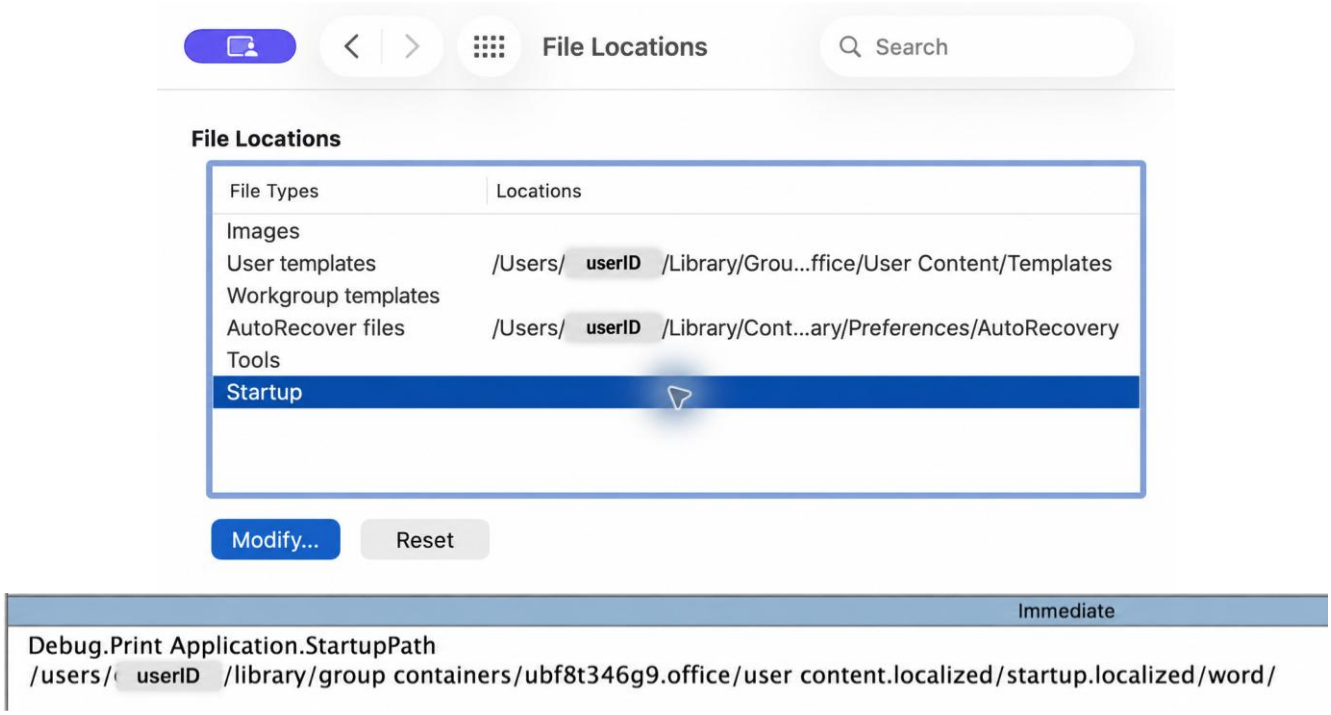
2. Choose Word > Preferences > File Locations, select Startup, and record the reported folder (Figure 1). If it is blank, choose Tools > Macro > Visual Basic Editor, click the Immediate Window toolbar button, enter only Debug.Print Application.StartupPath, and press Return. Copy the returned path, then return to Word. Close preferences without changing the location.

Notes

- Use the Startup path reported by your own Word installation, not User templates or the example path. Screenshot usernames are anonymized as userID.
- The tested Mac showed a blank Startup preference. The read-only Immediate Window query returned the active folder without changing preferences, code or modules. If you still cannot confirm the folder, use temporary loading below; do not reset or redirect Startup.
- The tested menu is Word > Preferences; some builds use Settings. Templates in the active Startup folder load when Word starts. Figure 1 shows both the blank field and the read-only fallback.

Figure 1

Find the Active Startup Folder



Install EquWord for Automatic Loading

3. Quit Word completely. In Finder, choose Go > Go to Folder (Command+Shift+G), enter the confirmed Startup folder, and copy EquWord.dotm there (Figure 2). Leave unrelated add-ins and Normal.dotm unchanged.

4. Start Word again. Check that EquWord.dotm is selected in Tools > Templates and Add-ins (Figure 3). Open Tools > Macro > Macros (Option+F8), run EquWord_About, and confirm version 1.0.1 (Figure 4). It should be available after restart without manual loading.

Notes

- Keep one EquWord version active. Back up an earlier EquWord template outside Startup before replacing it; do not edit the template itself. The template already contains the code, so no separate BAS, class or UserForm import is needed.
- For temporary loading, choose Tools > Templates and Add-ins. Under Global Templates and Add-ins, use + to select EquWord.dotm, keep its checkbox selected, and choose OK (Figure 3). A template loaded from outside Startup is normally available for that Word session only.
- Tools > Macro > Macros or Option+F8 opens Macros (Figure 4). Fn+Option+F8 may be needed when the function keys control hardware. Choose the command by name and select Run.
- Use macros only when permitted by your normal Word or organization policy. If Word blocks the template, use the normal approval process or ask your administrator. Keep security protections enabled.
- Open the supplied EquWord_Practice.docx and use File > Save As to save a separate working copy. Keep the original practice file unchanged. Manuscript and practice copies can remain .docx documents.

Figure 2

Place EquWord in the Confirmed Startup Folder

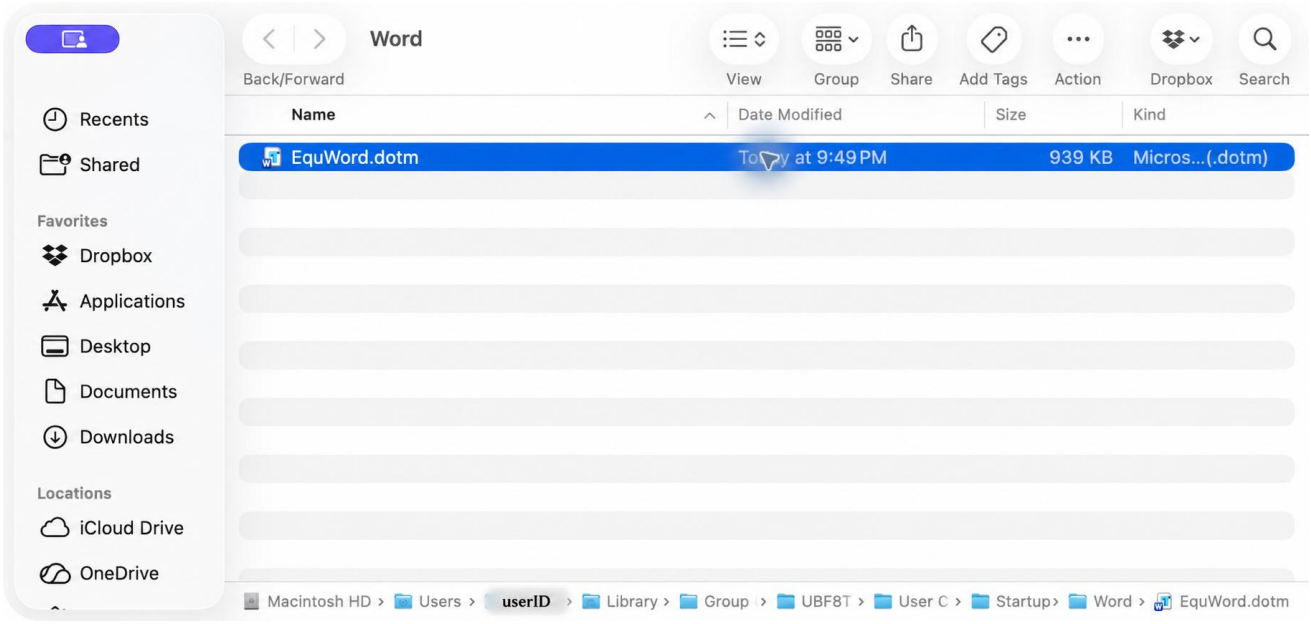


Figure 3

Verify the Loaded EquWord Template

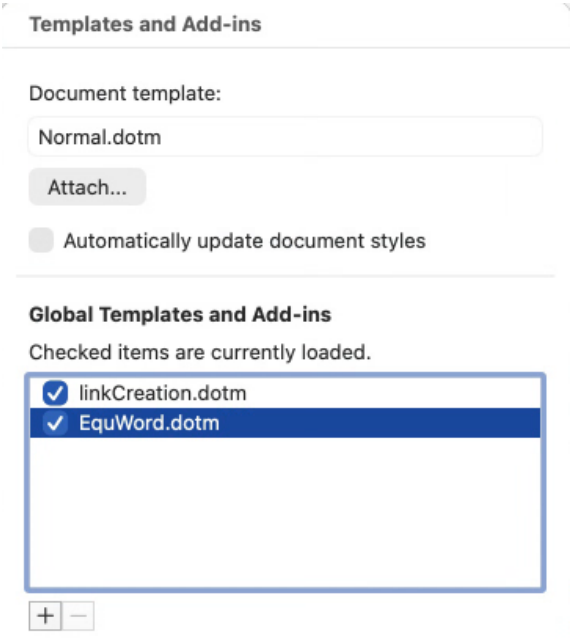
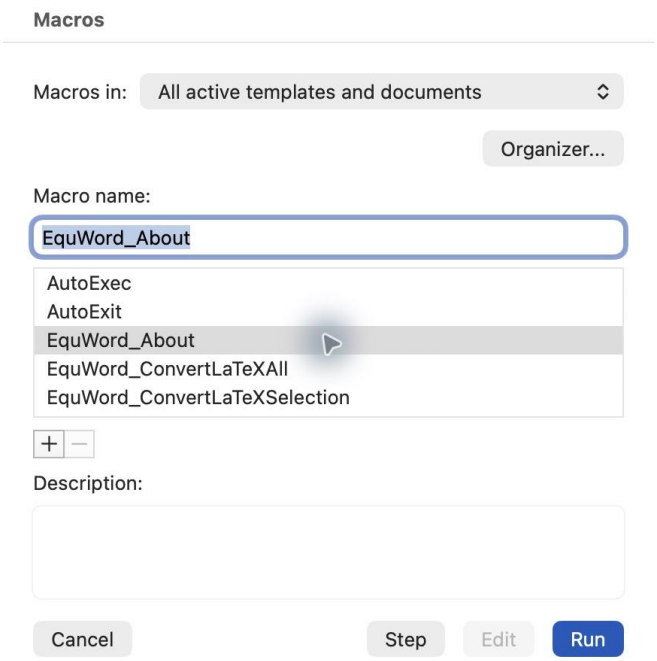


Figure 4

Run a Macro



Add Convenient Command Buttons

5. For optional Ribbon buttons, choose Word > Preferences > Ribbon & Toolbar and select Ribbon (Figure 5, Panel A). Use + > New tab to create a tab and default group. Select each, use the ellipsis (...) > Rename, enter EquWord or Commands as its Display name, and save the name. Set Choose commands from to Macros, add EquWord_* commands to Commands with the right arrow, and choose Save; then select EquWord in the main window (Figure 5, Panel B).

6. For a Quick Access Toolbar button, select Quick Access Toolbar in the same preferences window. Set Choose commands from to Macros, select a command, click the right arrow and choose Save (Figure 6). Add frequent commands such as EquWord_Settings, EquWord_FormatSelection, EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection and EquWord_SelectiveReformatSelection.

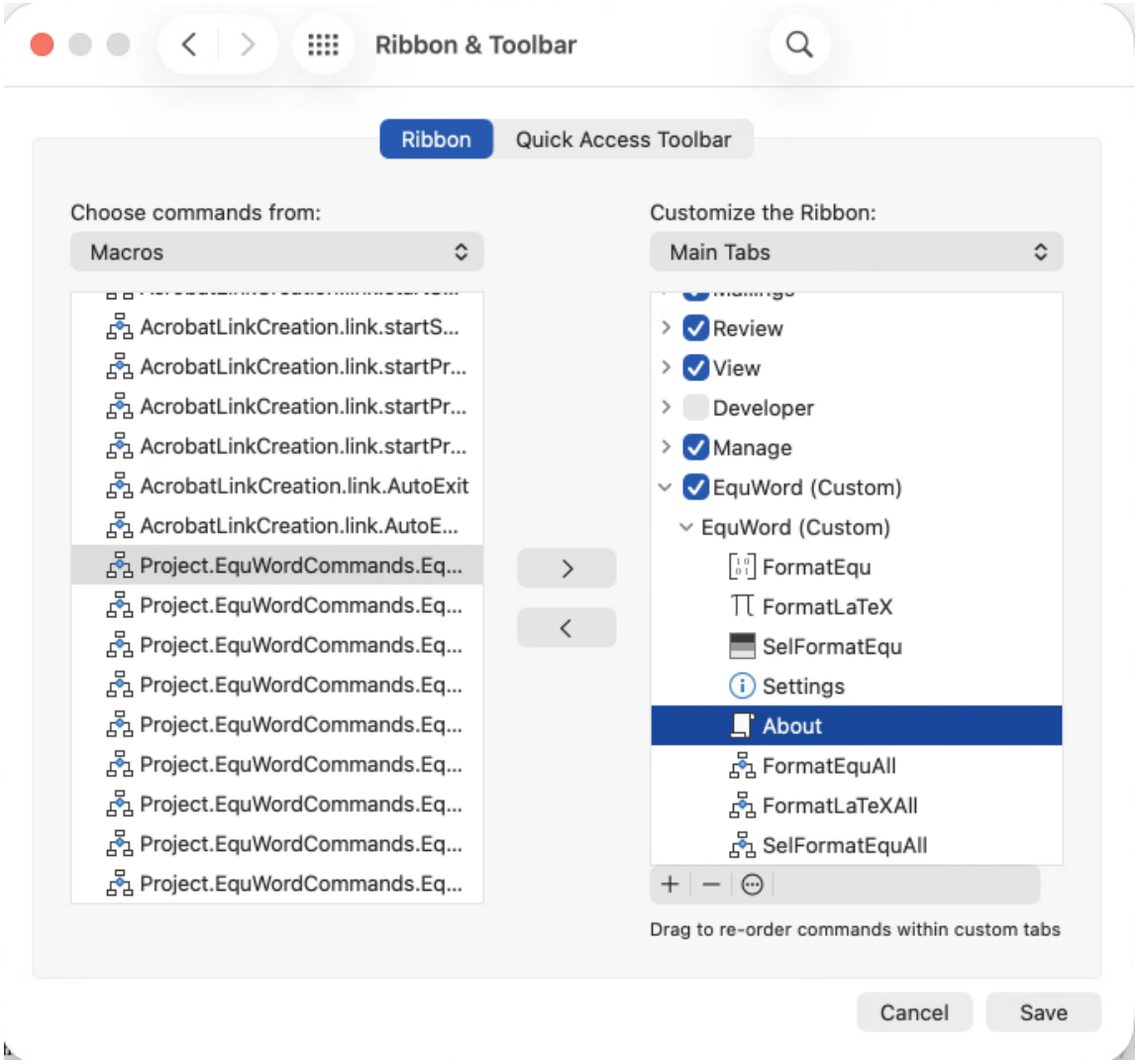
Notes

- Both Ribbon and Quick Access Toolbar buttons are optional. To use the Macros dialog instead, keep the manuscript window active, press Option+F8 (or Fn+Option+F8), select a command, and choose Run.
- Command entries may include a project or module prefix, and long names may be truncated. Match the final EquWord_* command name. A saved button may appear in the toolbar overflow under Show all.
- Preserve existing Ribbon and toolbar entries. If your Word build does not offer macros for either customization, use the Macros dialog instead; button availability does not affect template loading.
- These are personal Word customizations; loading EquWord does not create the tab or buttons automatically. A short button label does not rename its underlying macro.

Figure 5

Configure an EquWord Ribbon Tab and Toolbar

Panel A. Ribbon setup in Word Preferences



Panel B. Completed optional EquWord Ribbon and Quick Access Toolbar

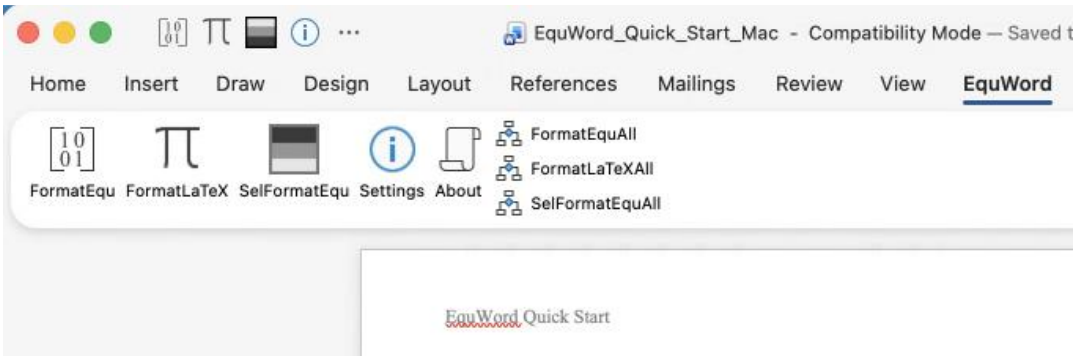
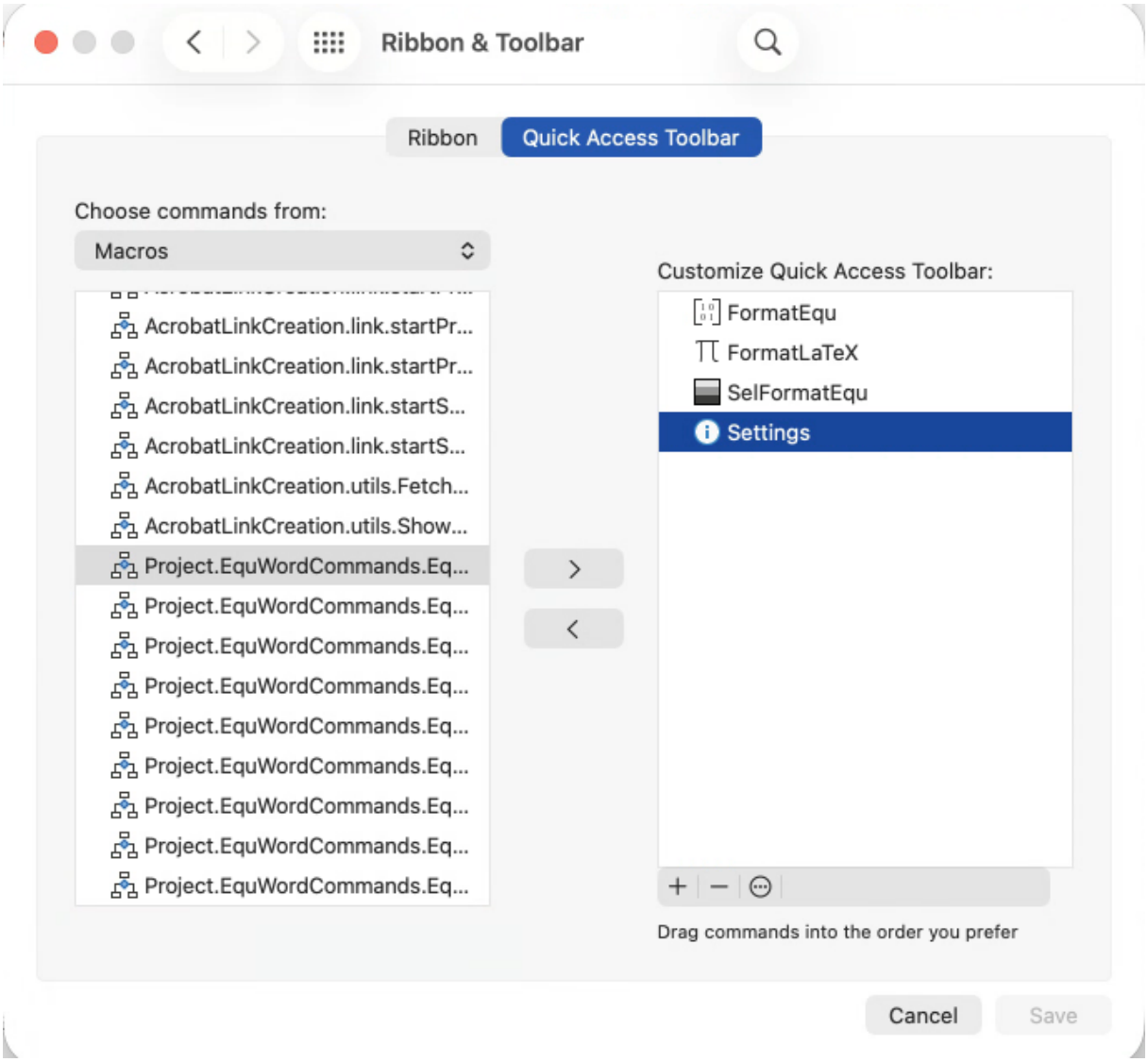


Figure 6

Add an Optional Toolbar Command



Save Settings for This Manuscript

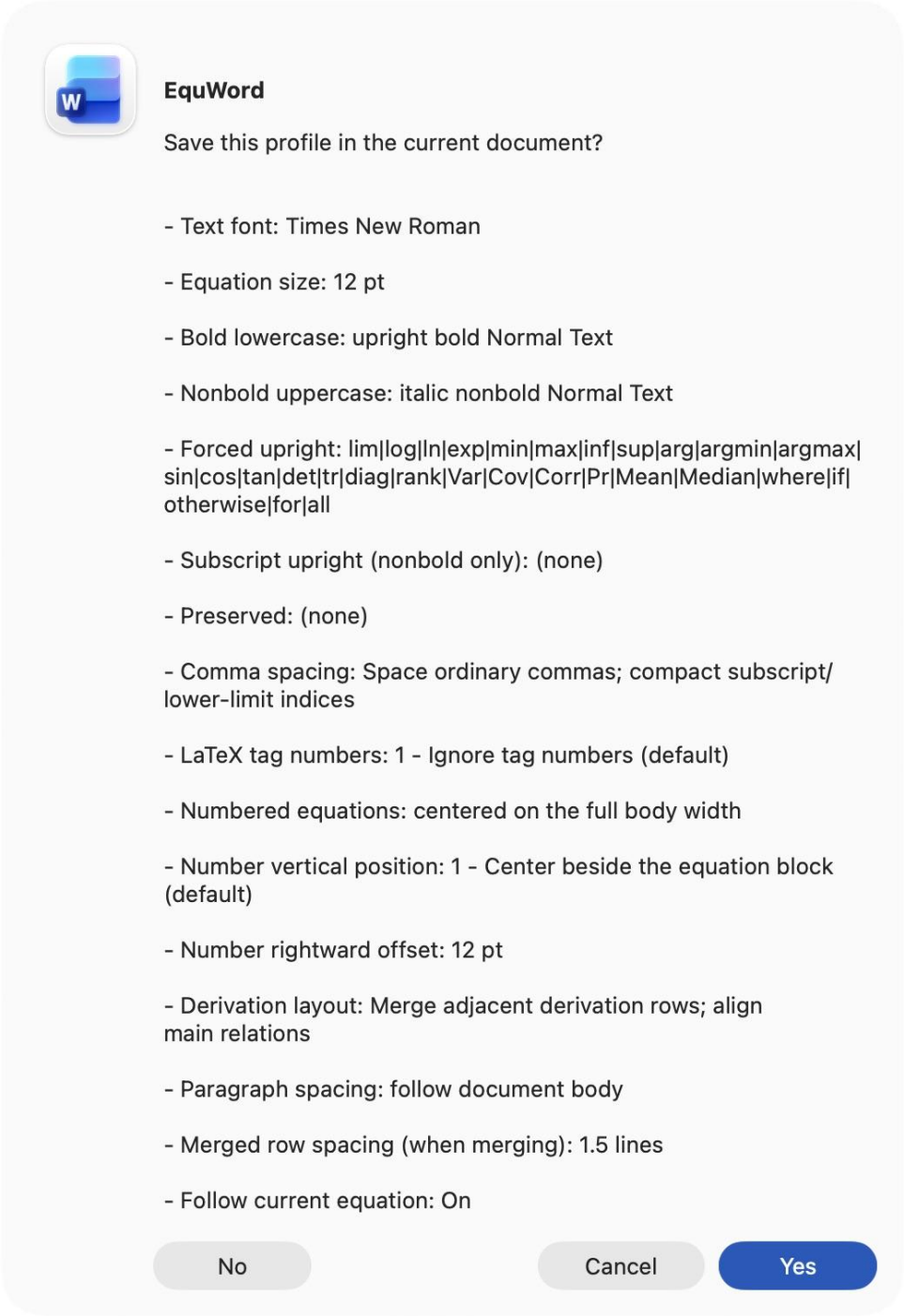
7. Activate the manuscript or practice working copy, then run EquWord_Settings. Work through the prompts for font and notation, multiline layout, internal row spacing, equation-number placement and Follow current equation. Review the final summary and choose Yes to save the profile in this document.

Notes

- For the practice examples, use Times New Roman 12 pt, multiline merging (option 2), 1.5-line internal spacing (option 2), and the default 12 pt number offset. Figure 7 shows the final settings summary.
- Set the body spacing to the manuscript format you need. Equation paragraphs follow that spacing; rows merged into one native equation use the separate internal setting. The new-profile default for merged rows is 1.5 lines.
- EquWord_Settings presents one prompt at a time. Recheck a document's saved profile after an update. Follow current equation controls whether Word displays each equation being processed; it is separate from the formatting categories.
- On Mac, the progress window shows the current task, equation count and processing time, independently of Follow current equation. Choose Stop or the window's close control to request a stop at a safe checkpoint. A blocking Word operation may delay updates or stopping. Earlier edits remain; review before saving.
- These settings control typography and layout. They do not determine whether a mathematical argument is correct.

Figure 7

Review the Manuscript Settings Before Formatting



Run the First Examples

8. In Exercise 1 of your practice copy, select the complete literal source \[y = x + 1 \], including both delimiters. Run EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection and confirm the intended scope and settings.

9. Read the compact result dialog. Run EquWord_LastReport only for full notes. Confirm one editable native Word equation showing y equals x plus one, without unwanted outer brackets. Save the practice copy.

10. In Exercise 2, click inside the existing native equation and run EquWord_FormatSelection. This formats native equations without LaTeX conversion.

11. For a separate conversion check, type \[v = \frac{1}{2} + \alpha \] in a fresh paragraph. Select the complete source and run EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection. Confirm that the fraction and Greek alpha remain editable (Figure 8).

12. In Exercise 3, select both complete equation paragraphs in the left cell of the numbered table. With merging and 1.5-line rows selected in EquWord_Settings, run EquWord_FormatSelection. Check one editable two-row block aligned at the equals signs, with its original number (Figure 9).

13. To change only some categories, run EquWord_SelectiveReformatSelection. Choose Deselect all, select the required categories, and choose Run (Figure 10). Select all restores all categories.

Notes

- Turn Track Changes off and work in the main document body. Headers, footnotes, endnotes and text boxes are outside these commands' scope. Select only the source, not the surrounding instructions.
- When merging, select the complete group in the left cell and retain its number in the right cell. A cursor in only one row requests single-equation processing. The outer equation paragraph continues to follow body spacing.
- Accepted category choices and Follow current equation are remembered for the document. Line spacing and equation-number table placement can be selected independently; multiline merge and alignment also applies line spacing. Structure, number-field and bookmark checks always run.
- EquWord_ConvertLaTeXAll processes supported source throughout the main body. EquWord_FormatAll formats native equations in that scope, and EquWord_SelectiveReformatAll applies selected categories. Use these only for intended whole-body processing; use selection commands for one block.

Figure 8

Inspect the Fraction and Greek Symbol

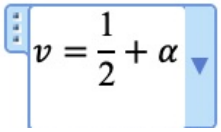


Figure 9

Review the Merged Block

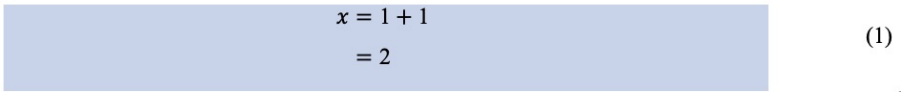
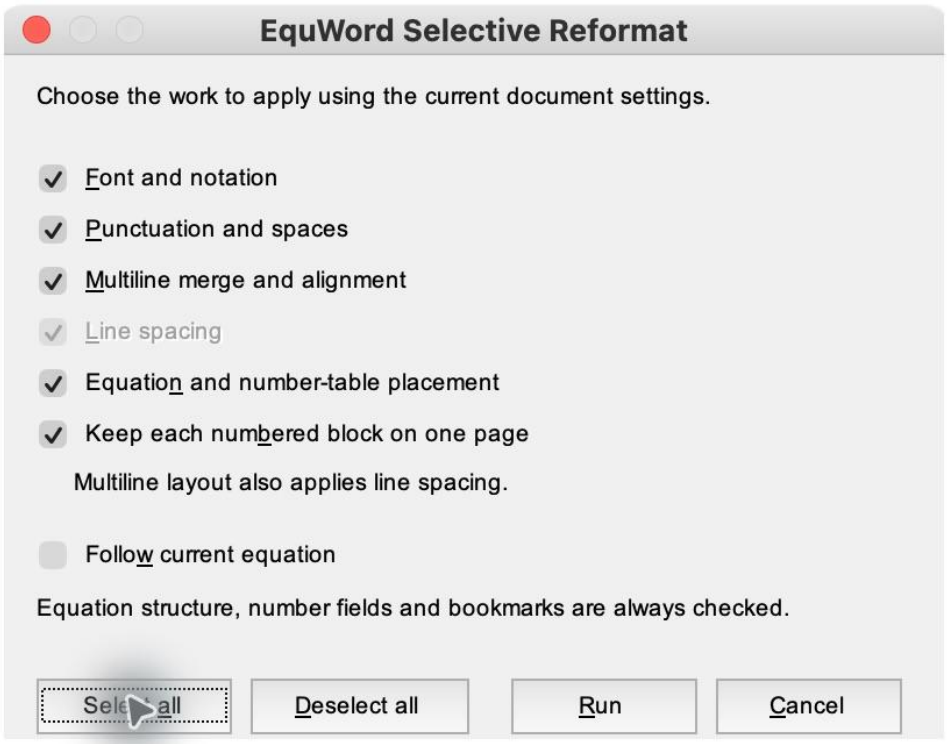


Figure 10

Choose Selective Work



Review and Save the Result

14. Check equations, adjacent prose, the equation number and reference text. Option+F9 toggles field codes on Mac (Figure 11); use it again to return to displayed values. Verify that the displayed equation number and reference still agree.

15. Save the practice working copy, close it, and reopen it. Click a native equation and rerun EquWord_FormatSelection to check ordinary repeat use.

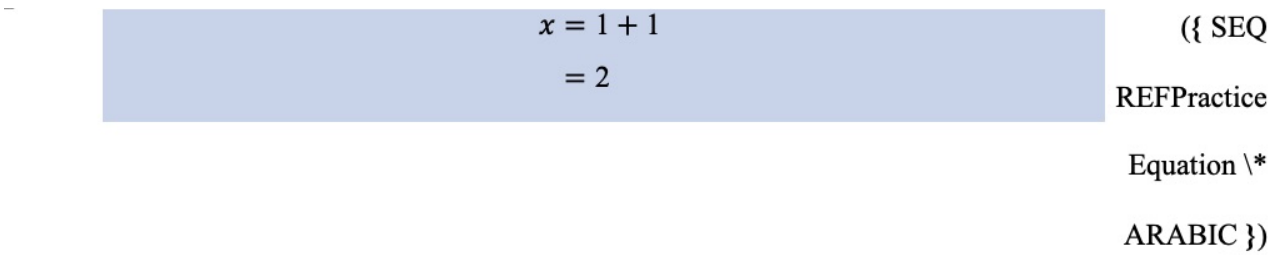
16. After restarting Word, run EquWord_About and confirm version 1.0.1, then open the saved working copy and format a native equation. If the commands are missing, check the confirmed Startup installation; temporary loading must be repeated for a new Word session.

Notes

- Fn+Option+F9 may be needed if your keyboard assigns hardware functions to the function keys. The field-code view exposes the SEQ number and REF reference; return to displayed values before checking the visible numbers.
- Mac shows one compact result dialog. Run EquWord_LastReport only when you need full notes; its report is protected and unsaved. Close it without saving. Mac has no automatic log-file saving or Esc polling. Keep a copy before substantial runs.
- Keep the original practice file, template and earlier results unchanged. If a block is retained for review, inspect the reported reason and the complete edited group before running it again.

Figure 11

Inspect Field Codes



Citing EquWord

If EquWord contributed to equation preparation in your manuscript, please consider citing the software in the Acknowledgments or another appropriate section. Cite the version you actually used. Citation is optional when using EquWord. Use only statements that reflect your actual use. Adjust the tools, tasks, software version, and singular or plural author wording as needed.

Example of software use

Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.1; Cho, 2026).

Optional example involving ChatGPT

Use this combined example only if you also used ChatGPT for drafting and revision.

> **Acknowledgments**
>
> ChatGPT (OpenAI) assisted with drafting and revision. The authors reviewed the AI-assisted content and take responsibility for the final manuscript. Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.1; Cho, 2026).

Reference

Cho, G. (2026). *EquWord: Equation conversion and formatting for Microsoft Word* (Version 1.0.1) [Computer software]. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23935877

This Concept DOI covers all versions. Include the version used in your citation.

Appendix: Command Reference

Table 1

Formatter Commands and Their Uses

Command	When to use it
EquWord_Settings	Set or update the current manuscript profile.
EquWord_FormatSelection	Format selected native equations, or one at the cursor.
EquWord_FormatAll	Format all main-body native equations.
EquWord_ConvertLaTeXSelection	Convert supported selected literal LaTeX and format it.
EquWord_ConvertLaTeXAll	Convert supported literal LaTeX and format the main body.
EquWord_SelectiveReformatSelection	Choose categories for selected native equations.
EquWord_SelectiveReformatAll	Choose categories throughout the main body.
EquWord_About	Show the loaded version and active document settings.
EquWord_LastReport	View the last run's full report on request. Protected and unsaved; close without saving. Available in this Word session.